



Sucher

A standalone device search – files, contacts and calendar events in one field. This guide covers setup and use.

Version 0.51 · GNU GPLv3 · split off from EdgeTab in 2026

Source & APK: github.com/8818freak/Sucher

All screenshots are from real use – personal content has been redacted.

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1 What is Sucher?

Sucher searches file *names* AND file *content* (text, Office, ODF, PDF, e-books, comic metadata, archive contents and music tags) as well as contacts, calendar events, SMS, calls and captured notifications – all in one field. Unlike an edge panel it isn't an always-on service: open, search, done.

Free, open source (GNU GPLv3), no ads, no analytics, no internet permission. Runs on any Android device from version 10.

2 Setup

First grant file access (its own system screen) and choose at least one folder. Easiest: the **“Search internal storage”** button adds the whole internal storage directly; **“+ Add another folder”** lets you pick more. Per folder you can enable **“Make content searchable”** – then the full text is indexed in addition to the name (more storage, takes longer).

Important when a permission changes: if a permission changes – e.g. an update adds a new one or widens an existing one – you must **revoke the already-granted permission in Android settings and grant it again**. Otherwise it stays ineffective even though it shows as “granted”.

3 Searching

Type into the field – it searches immediately. Category chips hide or show result kinds: *Files, Images, Videos, Music, Contacts, Events, SMS, Calls and Messages* – each kind gets its own result card. In content search, every hit shows the **matching passage as a snippet** with the found words **highlighted in colour and framed with »...«**. Images/PDF/e-books show a thumbnail; tapping it opens the large preview.

Search scope – where it searches

The “🔍 Search in” dropdown sets what is searched:

- **Everything (name + content)** – file names AND file contents at once (default).
- **Folder names** – the names of folders, including the whole folder path.
- **File names** – only the names of files.
- **File content** – the text inside books, PDFs, Office documents, etc.

Options

- **Match case** – “House” then no longer finds “house”. Default: off.
- **Search across paragraphs** – word sequences and the star may cross paragraph breaks (content only).
- **Limit the star's range** – the star inside quotes skips at most about 500 characters (content only).

Search terms & syntax

A few simple rules let you search very precisely:

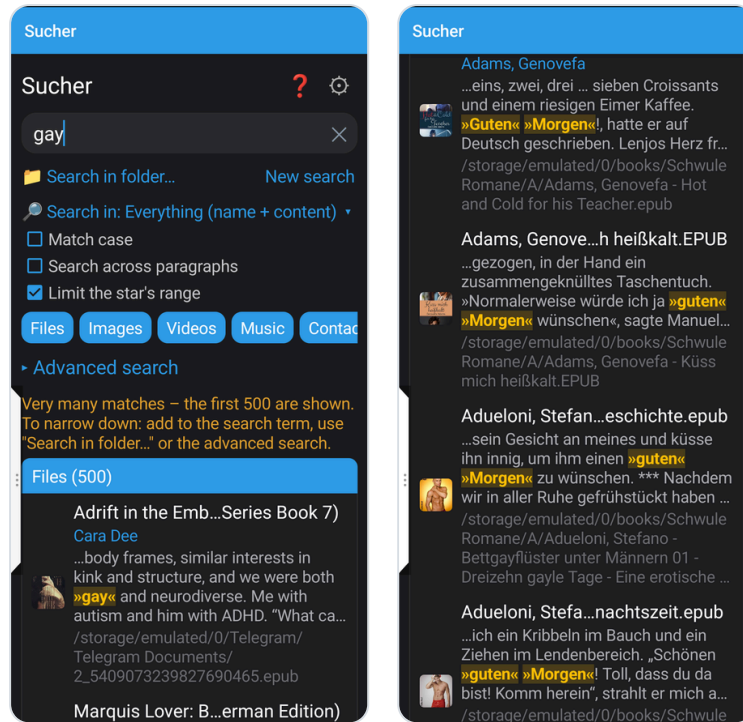
- **One word = the whole word.** “red” finds “red”, but not “redder” or “bread”.
- **Star * inside a word** as a wildcard: *red** (starts with red), **red* (ends with red), *r*d* (starts r, ends d).
- **Several words with spaces = a fixed sequence**, directly one after another: *good morning* finds only “good morning”, not “morning ... good”.
- **Two words that must both appear (anywhere):** put each in double quotes – “dog” “cat”.
- **A phrase in "...”;** a star inside skips word boundaries: “*red*light*”.
- **A minus excludes:** *novel -fantasy* finds novels without “fantasy”.

Tip: the question mark **?** at the top opens a quick help with exactly these rules, right inside the app.

Capture & search notifications: grant Sucher notification access and it can **record** incoming system notifications and keep them **searchable losslessly – even after you've swiped them away**. So days later you can still find a parcel tracking number, a confirmation/2FA code or a short message that would otherwise be gone. You choose **per app** which notifications are captured; what's already captured stays searchable even if you revoke access, and can be deleted anytime. Hits appear in the *Messages* category.

- **X in the search field:** clears the query text.
- **New search:** resets everything (text, scopes, advanced fields, filters).
-  **Search in folder....:** limits the search to one folder and its subfolders. Important: navigate to the folder first, then tap “**Search in this folder**” – a blue banner shows the active limit and clears it on request.
- **Recent searches:** a collapsible menu under the search field (while it is empty) lists the last search terms; tapping searches again, “Clear history” empties the list.

There is **no artificial result cap**: the card header states the full hit count and rows load incrementally via “Show more” (in steps of 50). For very many hits, use “Search in folder”, the file type, or “search only within these hits”.

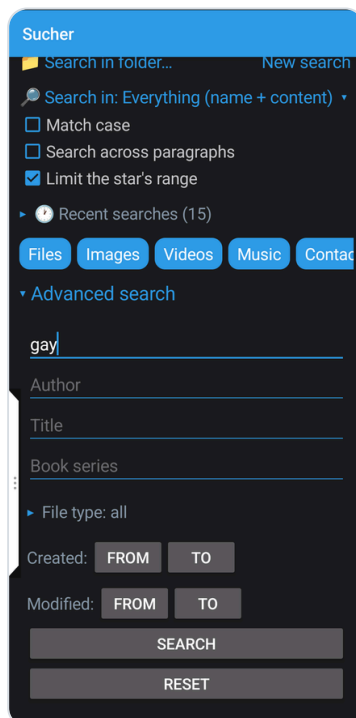


Search home screen

Full-text hits with snippet

4 Advanced search

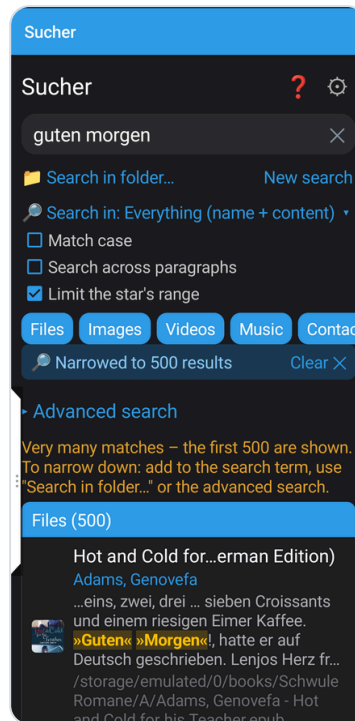
Via “Advanced search”, filter specifically by **file name**, **author**, **title**, **book series**, **file type** and **date** – ideal for large book and document collections. The text fields understand the same **syntax** as above (whole word, star *, word sequence, phrase "...", exclusion with -). All filled-in criteria are combined with **AND**; “Reset” clears the fields.



Author/title/series/type/date

5 Narrowing results

After any search, “🔍 **search only within these N hits**” restricts every following search to exactly that result set – repeatable, until cleared. A broad first search can thus be refined step by step instead of building one giant combined query.



Narrowing the result set

6 Index & automatic refresh

The index remembers each file's modification time and size and skips everything unchanged on the next run – so follow-up runs are fast. “Reindex now” starts a run by hand; “Automatically refresh in the background every few hours” keeps the index fresh. “Quit Sucher” stops a running index immediately. The progress line names the current phase.

Indexing runs in **three phases**: **Phase 1** captures only metadata (name, type, size, date) of *all* files very quickly – so every file is instantly findable by name, including those in large image, music and video folders. **Phase 2** then fetches full text (for folders with “make content searchable”) and book metadata in batches; **Phase 3** builds thumbnails in batches (they are also created on demand when displayed). This way the expensive full-text work on a large book folder no longer blocks capturing the other folders.

“Reindex” – does it wipe or extend the index?

It **extends/updates** it; it does not wipe it. A run walks the chosen folders and compares each file's modification time with the index: unchanged files are skipped, changed files are re-read, new files are added. Only files that no longer exist (deleted or moved) are removed from the index. An interrupted run therefore never leaves a broken state – just a subset the next run finishes.

What if a file is replaced by one with the same name?

It gets re-indexed. Sucher detects the change by **modification time OR size** – so a replacement is noticed even if it keeps the old modification time (as some tools do) but the size differs. On the next run the metadata and – if content indexing is enabled for that folder – the full text are re-read; the old content is replaced.

Why does indexing sometimes stop and restart?

That is intended and harmless. To save battery, Android gives each background pass only a limited time window; some devices end it after just seconds. Thanks to the fast **Phase 1** (metadata only) even a short window makes big progress, and each pass continues, by modification time/size, exactly where the last left off – nothing is lost, nothing is done twice. The compute-heavy full text (Phase 2) and thumbnails (Phase 3) are caught up gradually. For an immediate full pass, tap **“Reindex now”** and leave the app open (the foreground run has no time limit). Once the index is complete, later runs are short.

If a chosen folder isn't listable (e.g. “/storage/emulated” itself – only “/storage/emulated/0” is accessible), it is automatically mapped to the internal storage and the index is left untouched. A note about it appears in the diagnostics log.

7 Backup & restore

Settings AND the complete search index (all full text already captured) can be backed up to a file and restored from it – handy before switching devices, so the time-consuming indexing isn't needed again.

Thumbnails are deliberately *not* part of the backup (this keeps the file small; they are regenerated on demand). The **“Keep thumbnails permanently”** switch (settings) stores them in app-internal storage – then they survive “clear cache” (including tools like SD Maid); switched off they live in the cache and may be reclaimed under storage pressure.

8 Diagnostics

In the settings, a diagnostics log shows what the indexer did last and where it currently is (folder/file, counters). That makes it possible to see, without a cable, if something ever gets stuck; a “Problematic files” list names files that triggered a hang (and are therefore indexed by name only).